

1) The name of the disorder and a basic definition

The disorder I chose is Agoraphobia, which is an anxiety disorder where someone has an intense fear of crowded or public situations. These situations can cause feelings of being trapped, helpless, or embarrassed.

2) An interesting fact you learned about the disorder or it's treatment and a bulleted list of the most common symptoms

I learned that the disorder isn't just a fear of crowds; Agoraphobia is commonly caused by those trying to avoid the places and situations where they have panic attacks.

The most common symptoms are:

- A fear of leaving home alone.
- A fear of crowds or waiting in line.
- A fear of enclosed spaces, such as movie theaters, elevators, or small stores.
- A fear of open spaces, such as parking lots, bridges, or malls.
- A fear of Using public transportation, such as a bus, plane, or train.
- Your fear or anxiety is out of proportion to the actual danger of the situation.
- You avoid the situation, you need a companion to go with you, or you endure the situation but are extremely upset.
- You have major distress or problems with social situations, work or other areas in your life because of the fear, anxiety, or avoidance.
- Your fear and avoidance usually lasts six months or longer.

3) One new term you learned while doing this research and the definition of the word.

One new term I found out about was a common treatment for agoraphobia - cognitive behavioral therapy (CBT). CBT is a type of psychotherapy where a mental health professional and a patient explore the patients' unhealthy thinking habits by discussing their thoughts, feelings, and behaviors.

<https://www.nami.org/treatments-and-approaches/psychotherapy/> (Cognitive Behavioral Therapy section)

4) Link to resources for treatment options

Psychology Today - CBT therapists located in Bellingham, WA:

<https://www.psychologytoday.com/us/therapists/wa/bellingham?category=cognitive-behavioral-cbt>

Whatcom County Health and Community Services - Accessing Behavioral Health Services (PDF):

<https://www.whatcomcounty.us/DocumentCenter/View/69415/Accessing-Behavioral-Health-Services>